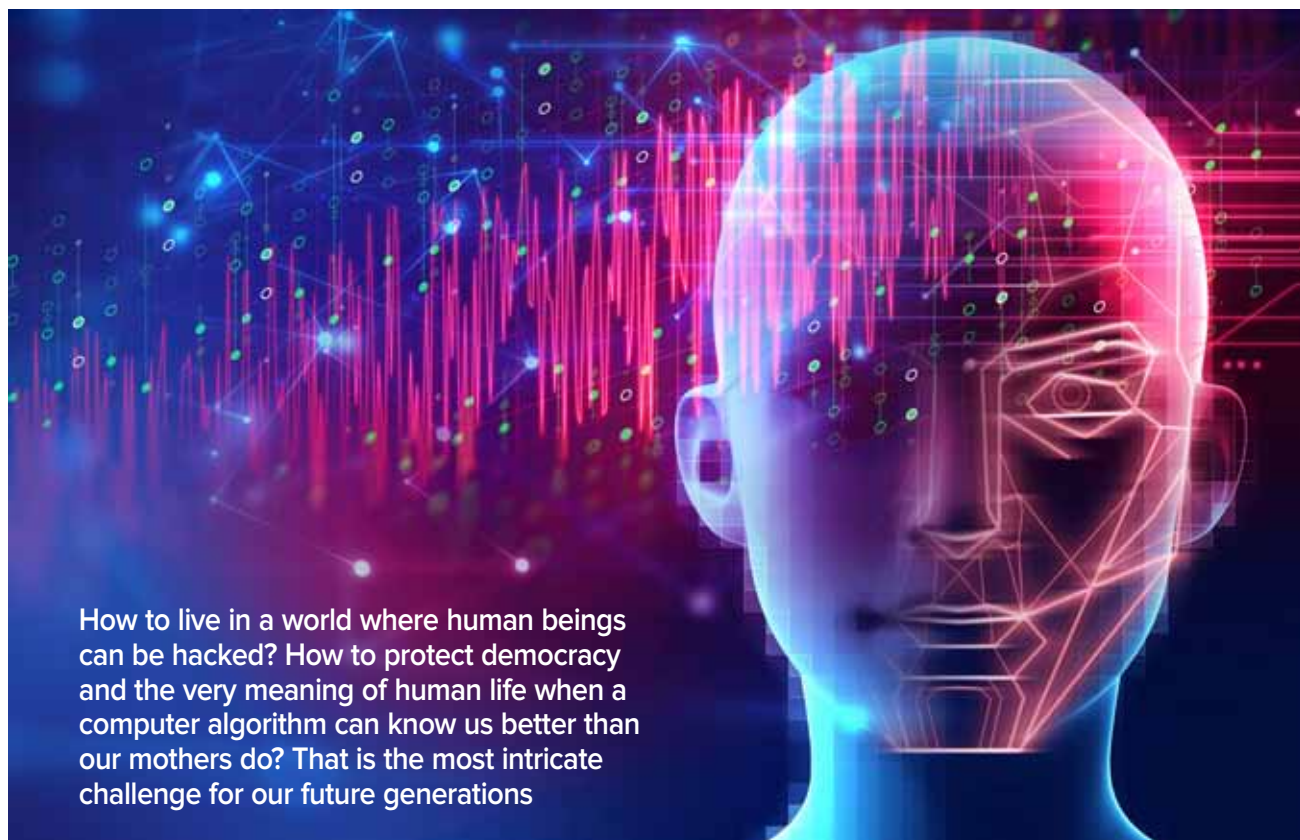




Hacking Humans: 21st Century Prophecy



How to live in a world where human beings can be hacked? How to protect democracy and the very meaning of human life when a computer algorithm can know us better than our mothers do? That is the most intricate challenge for our future generations

Dr Parteek Bhatia

The hacking of computers, smartphones, emails, and bank accounts is making headlines of news channels nowadays. But soon this would become run-of-mill news. The new entrant in the list of cybercrimes is the hacking of human brain and body as a whole. We are living in a world where the rise of artificial intelligence (AI) and bioengineering has increased the fear of technological disruptions. In the twenty first century, these technological advancements will prove that humans are hackable too!

The modern world identifies data as the new oil; big corporations and govern-

ment organisations have enormous data about us. Right from our daily movement and online searches to our purchase preferences, they know everything about us. The nightmare of upcoming disruption due to AI would become a reality when these organisations start monitoring and surveying the activities going inside our body and brain. This will bring us to a verge where human beings will become a hackable entity.

Dr Yuval Noah Harari has depicted this scenario very well in his book titled '*21 Lessons for the 21st Century*.' Fitness trackers, which have become a fashion statement today, constantly measure our heart rate